

EASIA 237 Qingming Module Unit 3.mp4

Welcome back everybody. This is the lecture for the third unit of our module on the Qingming Scroll in pre-modern and contemporary China, this one addressing the contemporary side of this module, focusing on several different examples, but most importantly theme parks, along with some additional points to consider from video games, murals, television shows, and a lot more. So what I'll be doing in today's lecture will first be giving a brief overview of some of those additional resources. I hope these will give you a lot of other things to think about, some of which I'll address directly in the lecture, some of which I'll leave up to you and then other parts of this will be useful, kind of one option for the assignment associated with this unit that I'll give you some more detail on at the end of the lecture. So after just a brief overview of what you'll see in that additional resources section, I'll talk just briefly about what some of these sources have in common and then perhaps some additional questions about other things we might think about as we look through all of these other sort of, I don't know if you want to call them adaptations, contemporary versions, participation in a sort of, but we can save some of that for the activity. After that I'll sort of focus back in on this idea of heritage, recalling some of the key points we made about this concept during our introductory module for the class, and then going over some additional details and perspectives that I think will be particularly relevant for the topic of today's class. After that, I'll move on to discussing the reading associated with this unit. This book chapter focused on theme parks and open-air museums, a kind of comparative study between two theme parks, at least partially inspired by the Qingming Scroll, and an open-air museum in the UK, of all places. So, after that, doing some kind of international comparison I'll think about some of the conclusions that the two chapters draw, and then start us thinking about some other points to consider, maybe other ways that we might do similar research that might focus on slightly different questions to continue exploring the contemporary legacy of this artwork and other aspects related to tourism, heritage, and entertainment, and all of these really interesting points raised in Ludwig and Huang's article. So in this case, that kind of concluding section is going to lead pretty directly into the assignment for this unit, which will be in short, asking you to sort of brainstorm a different kind of research project that might take a similar approach to the one we see in Ludwig and Huang's chapter, but which might focus on some different sources, all related to this Qingming Scroll and contemporary works inspired by it. After that, I'll have a bit more to say than usual about the quiz for this unit, and that's because we'll have not only a unit quiz focused on today's material, but we'll also have the module quiz after that, which is going to cover everything from this module. So the past three units will all be addressed in that module quiz. All right, so to jump into some of those resources, the first one you'll see is actually a work of art inspired by the Qingming scroll that you can see right here in Edmonton's Chinatown. This is a mural that takes its title from the work that inspired it along the river during the Qingming Festival. It was created by an artist named Chris Friesen in 2018. And you actually can go to look at this mural if you want to go out and explore in Chinatown on 97th Street just south of 107 Ave. It's kind of the south wall of a business called Gold Crown Jeweler. It's a little bit hard to see right now because I'm sort of facing a vacant lot. And I believe at least at the time of this recording the vacant lot is currently fenced off. So, you know, you don't have to make the trek out to see that. Perhaps an even better way to experience it, even though it

is right here in Edmonton, can check out the description of the mural from a website called Chinatown Stories. Lots of other really interesting content about Edmonton's Chinatown on that page. I've also shared a link to the artist's; he has some more images of the mural and some discussion of how it came to be, as well as a really interesting time-lapse video of how he painted the another sort of really interesting kind of document of how this piece of art was created. I don't need to say too much about this but one thing that I did find kind of interesting about it when you see the you'll see that it really sort of carefully recreates a lot of elements from the original scroll with some sort of interesting modifications that the artist discusses. And then one thing I wanted to point out, it might be a bit hard to catch when you watch the time lapse video; you can actually see he's kind of included a picture of the original scroll that he uses sort of as a reference as he's creating the artwork. So that's sort of interesting sort of method to consider when you watch that video. The next of these resources is something totally different. This is a recreation of the scenes from the inside the video game Minecraft. The game, admittedly, is something I don't know a whole lot about, but if you know Minecraft, you can kind of imagine what this might look like. What I've linked to is, unfortunately, not a way to, like, interact with the level itself if you are a Minecraft player. Instead, all I have is a link to a fairly comprehensive video of the level, and you'll see at the very end this is a three-dimensional kind of virtual world thing that can be sort of navigated in various ways. The very end of the video kind of recreates this experience of, like, watching a scroll from right to left, kind of panning over the entire scene. So that's a pretty interesting part as well. The reason, unfortunately, I can't like link directly to the level is that I believe this is only available in like the Chinese version of Minecraft, which I can't access from here. If you happen to be able to do this, perhaps you can check that out on your own. And yeah, I guess tell me what you think if you'd like. Then finally, what we have is, or rather not finally, final of the resources that I won't be talking a whole lot about in the lecture today is an episode from a television program. The connection between this TV show and The scroll is a bit more complicated, but basically this is a Chinese TV drama that finished airing not too long ago after the time this video was. The sort of complexity of this is that it's actually based on one of these intermediary adaptation sources, right? So this is in fact adapted from a series of novels; I think it's six volumes, perhaps even more. So, really, sort of expansive sort of fictional world, which is itself kind of inspired by the painting. But one thing to consider this is a very long series. I'm not asking you to watch the entire series or even the entire episode, but you might think especially about the first six minutes or so of the first episode during which we have a kind of like TV drama sort of reenactment of some of the scenes and that hopefully by now will be very familiar to you from having spent quite a bit of time looking at the scroll itself. So that would be, I think, the most important part to focus on, right? The rest of the series is quite interesting. It sort of goes in some kind of sort of suspense mystery directions after this. But, as you might imagine, the scroll itself is a single static image. And that's how much the series goes. A lot of places that aren't covered in the actual scroll. But the first six minutes or so are a fairly straightforward adaptation transforming the scroll into live action television, which is itself a pretty impressive technical and creative accomplishment. So then, after that, there are two, or rather three additional links. These are all just if you want to see more about the theme parks or open air museums that are the subject of Ludwig and Wang's chapter. So this includes one video for each of these three places: one video for the Millennium Park in Kaifeng, one for Song City in Hangzhou, and then one somewhat shorter video of the Beamish Living Museum in Durham. There's a lot of videos of all three of these places. discussed in the chapter. These are kind of tourist

attractions. People these days love to just put up videos of everything they've seen. So, if you're curious to see more, I tried to pick videos that have not too much narration, not too much extra, sort of like editorializing about what's going on in these places, but which give you just a kind of, hopefully, simulating what it might be like to actually visit these places. If you want to see more, you can search online on YouTube very easily. There's dozens to choose from. A lot of them have much more commentary and some explanation. But I thought if the chapter doesn't give you enough of a sense of what's going on in these places. These videos will help you appreciate that a bit more. They are quite long. As with all of these, for the assignment, you'll have the option to choose one or a couple of them to write about. If you'd rather not spend all this time looking through those, there are other options as well. But I do think that it'll be fun to have at least a glimpse at some of these resources. All right. So let's think about maybe some of the things that all of these different works inspired by the scroll might share. Just to give us a quick sort of visual sense of what I'm talking about, this, of course, is a detail of the Most famous scene from the scroll itself. Here is a sort of even more crowded day. I believe this is Millennium Park in Kaifeng, where we can see, in the midst of a kind of reenactment of some of the scenes from the scroll, accompanied by tourists kind of playing the role of some of the figures walking across the bridge in the original painting. And you can even see in the background here some reconstructions of those really interesting kind of scaffolding ornaments that we see on a lot of the buildings in the original scroll. And then here's a sort of heavily cropped, my apologies, sort of cropped screenshot from the Minecraft. level that's also inspired by the same scene. So, we might think of all of these things as forming part of the legacy of this scroll. All of these later examples are at least in some way kind of visually inspired by the original Qingming scroll, not just the sort of later imitations or sort of copies of it that we've talked a bit about in the first unit of this module. So, I guess a big open-ended question to ask is why. You know, beyond capturing the sort of visual similarity, right, what other elements of this painting's sort of theme or legacy are also brought back to the foreground when we see these recreations or new versions? Well One way to think about this is just that all of these might be inspired by the fact that the painting itself is something that is quite famous, right? It's a unique, original work that inspired many imitations in pre-modern history. And it's kind of gone on to become really a sort of representative example of the picture scroll form, if not the kind of pinnacle of the art form, right? I'm not sure how widely this label is used, but in our reading today, it's referred to as the Mona Lisa of the picture scroll form, right? Just a work of art that has itself come to kind of stand in for a whole period and whole stylistic tradition of scroll painting in China. So, simply reproducing the images from the scroll is in itself kind of participating in the celebration of the painting itself. There's more to it than that, right? There's lots of different scroll paintings, and indeed, art historians might have different perspectives on which other, you know, kind of hand scroll paintings are really the sort of pinnacle achievement of the art form. I think another thing that we should consider is the way that what's represented in the image, you know, because as we've seen, it sort of captures a kind of sort of peaceful and harmonious idea of kind of pre-modern idyllic urban landscape right. This is a theme that might exist in lots of other works of art, but it's one that I think is captured really effectively in the Qingming scroll. Of course, you know we also learned about a kind of iconoclastic interpretation of the scroll in the last unit that sees it not as a kind of idealized representation, but in fact as a sort of subtle critique of the period. But what we've also talked about is that the sort of legacy of the scroll is not this potential for it to be read as critique, but to certainly understand this as a kind of celebration of sort of

flourishing and peaceful period of history, at least in this kind of idealized nostalgic memory. And, but beyond that, and you know there's room perhaps for some scholars to debate the degree of like accuracy with which it represents these things. But it certainly presents us with a really detailed spectrum of lots of different activities, sort of aesthetic styles, handcrafts, you know these kind of sedan chairs that we see people being carried around on, different styles of pre-modern dress. It's an image that is itself, you know, a historical artifact, but it's one that also captures a lot of details about life and history that we might not necessarily get from other sources. And so All of this you know kind of contributes to what I've said about this sort of, but ultimately pretty peaceful urban environment that we see captured in the scroll. Another thing to think about with this is that the whole point of the second unit was pointing out that there are some things about the scroll that scholars don't really agree on that point to maybe some mysteries about what the scroll is representing, why the artist has chosen to paint it in this way. But this sort of legacy that's formed up in the wake of the scroll, the answers to these questions don't really matter. If we want to think about this scroll for doing. All of these things being a sort of precious expert work of art, being something that kind of captures a very appealing image of the pre-modern past and being one that, in spite of the questions we may have about the city we're talking about here, has a lot of sort of detail in it that we understand to represent something that at least feels very authentic. It feels like a sort of about different practices and activities that would have gone on more than a thousand years ago. But this isn't all of it, right? This is, I think, just part of it, and this is what we can kind of continue to explore by talking through those two specific examples. these theme parks and then also in your assignment for this week thinking about this perhaps in relation to some other kind of similar examples. So one of the things to lead us into the reading for today is to kind of some of the things we said about heritage during the introductory unit of the class. So the focus of that unit, if you recall, was on one of these kind of international governing bodies that serves as a sort of arbiter and defender of world heritage as it were, the sense of kind of an international process for the recognition and maintenance of these heritage sites. One thing that chapters like Ludwig and Wang's. asked us to think about, you know, these theme parks are not themselves UNESCO heritage sites. In fact, I'm actually not sure about the Beamish Museum, but I think it's highly unlikely that the Song City or Millennium Park are themselves considered world heritage. These are, you know, tourist attractions. They have, you know, a certain connection to historicity, a connection to the past. But even, you know, setting aside this debate about authenticity, I don't know that there is a kind of national or international governing body that is devoted to protecting the existence of this theme park, right? I hope the distinction there is. fairly clear right. But this is already kind of getting into these, like, alternate conceptions of who creates and maintains heritage that we'll be thinking about in this unit. But in the meantime, one thing we can think about is, you know, UNESCO is one, and perhaps the most internationally visible, of these agencies or organizations. But these are also things that happen on a national level. Certainly, you know, counties and provinces, and other sort of like subnational regional governments might also play a role in preserving, promoting, and maintaining these heritage sites or like intangible heritage practices. Something. that this chapter really encourages us to think about is what else is at stake in the contemporary oversight of these sites beyond just preserving them or making them available to new visitors. One thing that the authors of this chapter talk quite a bit about is how sites like this contribute to a sense of an inherited culture, which in its own right to a sense of identity that the people who participate in this contemporary site are going to form with one another personally

and within their communities, and so on. So they talk about the connection between participation in heritage sites like these and the creation and maintenance of ideas about contemporary culture and cultural or identity. They stop short of being too critical, or rather talking in a whole lot of detail about what some of these omitted factors might be, but they do make the point fairly prominently in their writing that these are recreated sites that are based on a selective vision of history. These are reenactments or replicas of things that may have existed at one point in history, but they do so in a selective and perhaps narrow way. So, this might be the sort of thing that might encourage us to think about some of these ideas about maintenance and creation of heritage. In relation to this other big idea from the share, the same goal of creating a new version of a kind of cultural or national identity goals are more oriented towards the needs of contemporary society rather than something that's exclusively or explicitly interested in preserving and maintaining something from the distant past. We have to think about both in relation to one another. So then, an extra layer of this, right? We might think of these kinds of agencies that take an interest in preserving, promoting, and maintaining these heritage sites and practices, why they might want to do this. But we might also think about how similar things kind of happen on a lot of other levels. So even if we're not talking about the government sort of, you know, taking a sort of hands-on interest in creating a sense of like shared national identity, of course, kind of similar things are happening on different scales, on a lot of different levels. And so, you know, I think we can maybe step aside from thinking about some of the motives or sort of consequences of this kind of like heritage maintenance and reconstruction and return back to this UNESCO-offered definition of what heritage is that, of course, we can think of as something that we can see in the world or like a process that we can observe happening that doesn't have anything to do with something like an international world heritage list, right? It doesn't have anything to do with sort of official oversight and maintenance from a government institution of any kind. That is, if we just think about this kind of broad definition that they provide, that heritage is the legacy from the past that we live with today and which we pass on to future generations, and we might start to think of a kind of broader concept of what heritage can mean if we think about it in relationship to other, you know, individuals or communities of people who might be involved in, you know, creating some way of establishing a connection to the past. And I think that this is something that can happen on a lot of different levels, right? We might think of this as something that's incredibly personal, even if we don't share it with anybody else. We can sort of imagine ourselves in relation to the people from the past that we feel some kind of connection to. We can do this in a community, perhaps a limited community, thinking about like a family and sort of current generation of a family and their relationship to generations of the past. We might think out somewhat more broadly from that, in a lot of different directions. So, what the authors of this chapter focus on, I think, is really a sort of commercial that is, you know, like a for-profit way of using heritage— of sort of making use of heritage in this very broad sense: some kind of legacy from the past that people are interested in today to create something that can serve the people who run these theme parks. But the way that this sort of commercialized perspective on the maintenance and promotion of heritage— how this interacts with the individuals and families and communities that also engage with this— is a pretty complex question. And it's one that I think the authors of this chapter raise some really interesting questions about. So one of the many sort of flavors of question that the authors raise in this chapter is about this issue of authenticity, which we've already talked quite a bit about in the introductory unit, but which I think they give a sort of complimentary perspective on and really sort of think outward from there, right?

That is, once we get away from this idea of authenticity as requiring some kind of adherence to like original materials or things like this, we open up the possibility to recognize things like intangible cultural heritage. But then we also open up the possibility for things like historical fantasy, a kind of selective visions of the past, and all of these other ways of thinking about this legacy of history that aren't necessarily that tied to this very narrow concept of authenticity. And this is both really interesting, really important for contemporary audiences as they think about the past, but also a somewhat tricky situation to deal with for reasons that I think are expressed quite well in the chapter that we're reading for today. So let's talk a bit about that. The title of the chapter: Contemporary Fabrication of Pasts and the Creation of New Identities, Open Air Museums. and Historical Theme Parks in the UK and China. As we've seen before, this is another good example of a chapter in an edited book, in this case from a book called *The Heritage Turn in China: The Reinvention, Dissemination, and Consumption of the past*. We can see the image on the cover is taken from another one of the case studies in the book, with a sort of kind of similar to some of the things that we see in this chapter, but about a different location. So we don't need to worry too much about that. But basically, this book is a more or less of case studies on different examples of tangible and intangible heritage in contemporary China. The introduction which I've not asked you to, but which is sort of referenced and as usual, the sort of additional reading slide at the very end of this kind of situates these scholars' interest in this topic in this like post-1980s period during which there was, to quote the authors, a sort of reawakening of interest in cultural heritage, especially kind of pre-modern cultural heritage in China beginning in the 1980s and continuing really through the present. So they're thinking about a sort of revival of interest in the past that began with a lot of different policy reforms and changes in perspective on culture and society. In China in the 1980s, the book covers a wide variety of topics: architecture, performance, visual art. They're all sort of addressing these topics in relation to national and cultural identity, issues of tourism, diplomacy, and lots more. So, a lot of ground is covered in this book. The chapter that we have read is written by two scholars who happen to be two of the editors of the book itself. Their specialization is in like urban planning, basically. They're scholars of civic design and these kinds, based in Xi'an, China, and Liverpool, UK, at least at the time of writing of the book. I'm not sure where either of these scholars are today. The focus of this chapter, though, is on case studies— a sort of comparison of case studies about one open-air museum in England and two historical theme parks in China. And they advance a pretty interesting argument, but it's a sort of different kind of argument to what we've seen in our earlier units in this module. It's an argument that I think really raises more questions than it. But basically, I think one of the things they accomplish in this chapter is that they very effectively challenge this kind of, at this point, outmoded and exclusive focus on the preservation of original materials. This is a topic we've already discussed in some detail in the introductory unit. But where I think they push this a step further is in the kind of questions they raise about what is the situation now that we have kind of set aside this really narrow idea of authenticity as the only way that we define what can constitute like serious cultural heritage, right? And so they sort of take this argument in some interesting directions about especially, I think, the sort of selective vision of the past that comes up in both of these sites. So I wanna begin just by quickly talking through some of the points they raise about the first of these three sites, even though obviously. This class is not about the UK since they do cover it in the book. I think it's worth kind of talking through. So, in brief, what they're talking about here is a sort of open-air theme park, open-air museum that's really an entirely reconstructed coal mining village,

right? So, this is not the site of like an actual historical town. It's made up of buildings that were sort of brought in from other places and those that were sort of built as replicas, sort of in the style of buildings that would have existed in these two points in time. So, what they point out in the is that the theme park is kind of divided into two what are called like time zones right. It's a pretty clever label. One of these focuses on the early 1800s, far beyond the living memory of anybody who might be sort of visiting the site today, and one inspired by the early 1900s, which at the time of the theme parks might still have represented the sort of childhood memories of some of the oldest possible visitors to the theme park. But at this point, there are probably not too many people still around today that have a sort of living memory of what cities like this would have been like in the early 1900s. So I think it's kind of interesting to point out a sort of like addendum to this. I'm not sure at the time of the writing of this chapter, if this was the case. But at present, they've kind of expanded the museum to also include some parts like inspired by the 1950s and some things that might be sort of closer to the actual like childhood experiences of some of the guests. So there's a way that this is itself a kind of evolving site that responds maybe to some of the new interests that people might have as they visit the sort of, you know, what they expect to see as visitors to a reconstructed historic city. So, as I mentioned, this is not on the site, I believe. I mean, there may have been a city there at one point, but most of what we see on the site are like reconstructions or relocated buildings or these kinds of replicas. And it's also a site of historical reenactments, right? So visitors to the museum don't just sort of walk around and look at the buildings, but they can interact with people who are in presumably period-accurate costumes that are sort of simulating the roles that would have been played by different people living in the city and then talking to guests about the sort of roles that they're playing, presumably in character. As the writers point out, this is a situation in which the people who designed this museum have really striven for accuracy and historical authenticity. And yet, as the authors also point out, this is sort of inevitably like an incomplete and selective version of the past, right? So we do have a very sort of lifelike and vivid recreation of different periods in the history of this region. It's one that might be sort of, in terms of what aspects of these periods of history do we really want to bring to when people are visiting this, presumably on holiday, on their days off with their families. It's not meant to be 100% accurate of all of the pros and cons of the historical period. It presents a kind of idealized version of the past. So there is sort of educational element to the existence of museums like this, but it's also a tourist site, right? It's something that we go to for entertainment, not necessarily just to learn about the past. And as the writers point out, it seems to be one of the kind of intended goals of the creation of a museum like this: to inspire a sort of nostalgic pride, right? Of how things used to be, maybe creating history as we want to remember it, not necessarily as it actually was. So hopefully there's already some points of similarity there based on some things that we've talked about in relation to even the earliest version of the scroll itself: the sense of memory versus nostalgia and these kinds of idealized representations of the past. But let's think not about that original scroll for now, but some of these theme parks, at least in part, are inspired by the images from the Qingming Scroll. So the first of these is Millennium City Park in Kaifeng; that is the city that is, you know, conventionally thought to be the one that we see in the Qingming Scroll itself. But like the Beamish Open Air Museum, this is not the actual structure that you know perhaps might have inspired the painting like this, but a kind of recreated version of it that is actually inspired by the painting itself, right? So This isn't an actual sort of architectural site, even though it is in or near the city of Kaifeng. This is something new, but it was built in the style of what

we see in this scroll. And the second one they discuss is a kind of similar example of an open-air theme park, but this one is in the city of Hangzhou, which is, you know, not the northern Song capital, but it was the capital of the southern Song, so it has this kind of appeal to kind of like authentic Song dynasty history, just a sort of slightly different phase of it. But the city itself, as you can see, also draws inspiration from the illustrations that we see in the scroll. This one a little bit less distinctively, but it's quite similar to the city gate structure that we see in the kind of final third of the scroll. So they both feature like architecture and scenes that are very directly inspired by the Qingming painting. But it's not just a place you go to kind of find yourself immersed in the imagery of the painting. There's also, as they discuss in great detail in the chapter, and which you can see if you look through some of those videos in the resources for this unit, these become sites for a lot of other different kinds of like heritage activities. Right? There's other structures; there's lots of different kinds of performances there's traditional crafts and food, and lots of things that do call to mind some version of pre-modern times, but also to be clear, lots of just kind of tourist activities that don't necessarily have really anything to do with pre-modern times. Right? These are, I think, first and foremost like theme parks that have a kind of historical theme that kind of dictates some of what goes on inside them. So again, some of these are directly inspired by kind of traditional crafts, and others are just the same kinds of activities that you might expect to see in any kind of like open-air theme park environment. So one of the interesting points that the authors make here is that there's not really, there aren't a lot of claims to authenticity that are made in the kind of promotional material for this park. So, unlike the Beamish Park, this kind of dedication to a kind of recreation of the past doesn't really seem to be one of the like explicitly articulated goals of these theme parks, right? This is not really mentioned in any of these promotional materials, and we might understand the focus then to be on this kind of like idealized sort of romanticized version of the culture of that particular historical period, the Song era, but also a sort of chance to like live out a sort of period of historical fantasy that never actually existed and which I don't know that anybody. The point is not to say like, oh this is just like it would have been in the past, right? This is sort of living in a world of fantasy that might have more to do with contemporary like television and films and novels and other sort of works of the imagination rather than sort of effort to really authentically recreate the atmosphere of any particular historical period. That is, that it's inspired by contemporary trends and interests that might also be some way of interacting with or finding value in some version of the distant past but which isn't necessarily super focused on any one historical period in particular. But another way of thinking about this, if there is any single model for anything that we see going on in these parks, it's not an effort to recreate the Song Dynasty, but it's an effort to recreate what we see in the painting. Thinking back to what I said about the legacy of the, regardless of anything else about this painting, its connection to the authenticity of what the painting itself represents, the ability of the designers of this theme park to create something that calls to mind the images of that painting is for its own sake, a different kind of authenticity. You might walk through the theme park and say, oh, this is just like I'm walking through the painting, even if you're not necessarily thinking, oh, this is just like I'm living in the actual Song Dynasty. These are two different ways of thinking about. So we might understand a reenactment of the painting as something that is slightly different from a reenactment of the historical period that the painting is thought to represent. So, before moving into some conclusions that the authors draw through their comparison of these two sites, just because this is a kind of different style of scholarship I think it's worth returning to the ideally before you take either of the

quizzes for this editor module and finding your own answers to some of these questions. Right? Unlike some of the other studies we've read, these are studies of complex contemporary sites that we can actually visit and engage with, and that we can think about as being represented in a variety of other sources. So, I think it's important to pay attention to where does the evidence that Ludwig and Huang analyze actually come from. What you'll find is that, in addition to talking about the theme parks themselves, perhaps inspired by their own visits to these sites, they also make reference to things that we can call primary sources but are also kind of not the theme parks themselves, right? So we're talking about promotional materials, perhaps like websites, pamphlets, brochures, images, recordings that are taken of those sites. Perhaps they might refer to some documents related to the commissioning or construction of these sites, like a charter that they might have. So, in addition to the theme park itself, there's a whole lot of supporting evidence in other media that might also be useful to consult in studies like this. And then, another thing that we should pay attention to how they make use of the work of other scholars in their analysis. We might think the most obvious would be to think about, in the case of the Qingming Scroll, hopefully this stood out to you. One of the sources they cite is Xingyuan Cao's article about the Qingming Scroll itself, right? So we might think about how they sort of draw on the work of other scholars to understand more about the historical context for those original sources of inspiration. And it's worth sort of looking through the other kinds of studies that are cited and thinking about how they're using those in their own writing. But one thing that's maybe a little different about this chapter is that they also sort of use other scholarly perspectives on those two theme parks in a kind of here is where you'll often find cases where this distinction between primary and secondary source gets a little bit blurry, right? So they're talking about other scholarly perspectives on the open-air theme parks or the historical theme parks, for example. But what they're saying in the section where they address this is that even among scholars, this sort of issue of authenticity doesn't seem to be a big sticking point, right? That the sort of scholarly perspective on the emergence of these kinds of historical theme parks often interested in discussing other aspects of them rather than the degree to which they sort of accurately represent Song Dynasty styles or anything like this, right? And so these are, in a sense, we can think of them as kind of complementing some of the evidence that is cited in the article about just what visitors to these sites in general think about them, right? So there's this kind of layering of that Ludwig and Wong analyze in order to understand, well, what do people think of these theme parks, whether we're talking about regular sort of tourist visitors to those sites or if we're talking about scholars who've done sort of similar work analyzing their significance from other perspectives. So, that's one difference, right? But I think it's also worth thinking about a kind of bigger difference in terms of how the argument is, how the sort of thesis is articulated and defended, that makes studies like this, in some ways, more challenging, I would say, than reading articles like those we read in the last unit. But they also might open up like some more sort of creative possibility for us to ask new questions about these sources. So, I would say in the case of Xingyuan Cao's, she has a very clear thesis statement. right A very clear argument about what this scholar believes to be true about what we see represented in this. And then that argument is sort of supported and defended through the analysis of additional evidence. So in this case, I think, you know, most of the points that she makes in this are very easy to connect back to her like overarching argument. In the case of Ludwig and Wang's article, this is not really the case, right? It's sort of hard to say, well, here is the single point that these authors are trying to make by writing this. And then here is how every

sort of piece of evidence they cite connects back to that argument. But there is still kind of a value in this sort of scholarship, right? They're raising a lot of questions that I think they expect their reader to sort of think about on their own, right? And think about how they might answer those questions or think about perhaps what else we might need to consider to really come up with definitive responses to those questions. And they also address a lot of sort of theory about heritage and the heritagization process that we've discussed a little bit, these sort of ideas about what constitutes heritage and what people do with it without necessarily arriving at a very firm conclusion, right? So they're sort of testing these theories out, encouraging us to think about them in different ways and without necessarily like dictating a response from their readers. And so these are things that I think you can consider as you read or perhaps reread this, and which you might want to draw on as you write your own much shorter responses in the assignment that I'll talk about in just a few minutes. Another question that's worth asking, right, is that this is a fairly novel selection of case studies for comparison, right? So you might want to think about, well, how would this article be different if they were asking some of these same like theoretical questions, but we're focusing only on one of these three sites as a case study. So what's the value of the comparison that they provide us with here? And then when we've thought about that, we might also want to think about, well then, why is it that these three sites are the ones that they've? And what are they able to do using these three specific locations in their analysis that might not be possible if they used other options to consider? On the other hand, and this will also be useful for the assignment, you might want to think about sort of related or additional questions that we could ask if we were using a different variety of examples in a sort of complementary case study. So let's think a bit more about this comparative issue, right? I would say one of the more definitive points that they make in this article is that whichever of these sites we're talking about, they all represent a kind of selective approach to historical reenactment. Part of this is sort of by necessity, right? It would take sort of lots of resources to create a sort of 100% authentic representation of any distant historical period, but part of it certainly must be by design, right? It certainly must be deliberate. And one of the reasons that might explain some of these selective choices is that one of the goals that inspired their creation was to increase tourism, right? As sort of entertainment, as leisure time activities for people to experience on their day off. These are not necessarily meant to challenge or provoke, even though at the same time they do offer their visitors a chance to kind of experience living heritage in one form or another. So this issue of nostalgia is also quite interesting, right? When we think about nostalgia in the sort of literal sense, what we're talking about is someone's own memories of what they recall to have been like a nice time in their own history. This gets more complicated when we experience nostalgia not for our own past but for distant past, for things that we didn't actually experience and can't ourselves remember. It's a very interesting feeling, right? A sort of complementary, sort of emotional experience to other kinds of heritage practice. They also draw attention to the way that this sense of nostalgia for something that we didn't actually experience can also create a sort of sense of shared heritage and shared identity, right? Which in its own way is kind of to a sort of national sense of belonging; though in both of these cases we don't really see the sort of national governments of either of these places playing a very strong role in kind of dictating what kinds of cultural identity they promote, right? So we get a sort of sense of the, like less, how should I put it? The ways that these kinds of senses of national cultural identity can come into being not through like dictation from some kind of national government, but through like a lot of different factors working in conjunction with one another. But they also

raise some questions about who the sense of belonging applies to. When we create a kind of selective version of history, the one hand this is surely not representative. of the histories of everyone who constitutes like a modern citizen of that nation, right? We know both of these places have, in part, been defined by migration: the arrival of new populations. There are also places that have, in different degrees, like sort of complexity of especially pre-modern identities that's not necessarily represented in the kind of modern national memory of each place's distant past. And I'm trying to remain somewhat ambiguous here just because I want to summarize the, as it's presented in the chapter. So, I think it's also really interesting that in both of the case studies, they stopped short of saying. really exactly who or what they're talking about here. They simply raised this question of who is actually represented in the sort of that's preserved and sort of reconstructed and recreated in any of these sites. And I think there are kind of two sides to this, right? I think on the one hand, maybe one reason to sort of focus on this kind of idealized or positive image and to kind of present this to everybody is certainly to achieve some kind of inclusivity, right? Regardless of the complexities of, I would imagine, the people behind both of or rather all three of these sites want like all visitors to feel sort of like welcome and included in the kind of contemporary reimagined version of that past right. But on the other hand, there's also some kind of like idealization of these elements of history that might sort of leave out some people who would have been present in the histories of these places that maybe don't see themselves kind of represented in their contemporary versions right. So this is idealization; not everybody's ideal version of the past is the same right. So other things to think about there, it comes to the between all three of these places. I think the clearest difference that the authors point to is that in the case of the Open Air. Museum in there are some serious claims to like educational value, claims to authenticity. And this is a sort of point of pride in the like inspiration for the museum itself, right? There is this kind of idea that when you visit the site, you are learning something about the past, and it's presented in such a way that you feel like you're learning something about like an authentic version of the past, right? So the sense of a claim to is much more a part of the like promotional material and the kind of idea behind the Beamish Park, what we see in any of the sort of supporting media from either of the two Qingming Scroll-inspired theme. parks. So they might present themselves as being more experience-centred, more sort of entertainment-centred, perhaps again with this exception of offering like an authentic experience of living inside the, which of course is a painting, which we understand to itself be kind of idealised and romanticised to some degree. So there's another difference there between, you know, the sort of claims to authenticity on one hand, but then the reality, which is a kind of selective version of history that's kind of chosen to be reenacted, which is nevertheless kind of presented as a form of versus, you know, in the case of the Song Dynasty. theme parks something that I think is fairly overtly presented as a fantasy, right, without these kind of claims to authenticity of any like specific historical period being made. So then a question we might ask about this is, what does, you know, if we think of engagement with a kind of fantastical version of the past, how do we think of this as, right? What does this have to do with how we might understand heritage in other contexts? Kind of interesting point of comparison to think about; there might be tempting because, you know, one of these examples comes from one nation and two of them come from another. I think it's sort of natural. to assume that part of what's at stake here is some kind of implicit comparison between, you know, different national cultures or perhaps at least national governments. I do think it's important to point out, though, that these are not the kinds of that the authors draw from this comparison, right? They

don't say, in conclusion, this means that like England is like this and China is like that, right? They keep their conclusions limited to the sources that they're evaluating, even as they point to how those sites might connect with other ideas about broader issues in other ways. So the final thing to consider, and this is going to lead directly into the activity for this unit is how some other examples for comparison might also affect some of the conclusions that we're able to draw about some of these sites. Right? So this is a fairly deliberate choice of examples, and it's certainly not the only comparison that's possible. So what we're going to do for the assignment is to think about maybe some other opportunities to compare different elements of this kind of contemporary legacy of the Qingming scroll, either with one another or with other examples of this kind of like living cultural heritage, this kind of tourism-based heritage, sort of experiential. stuff that we've read about for this week. So like all of these writing assignments, this is very open-ended. The point is to encourage you to kind of think and develop some ideas about this, not to create like a fully polished and defensible thesis about any one thing in particular. This is sort of simulating the beginnings of developing a research project, right? So try not to stress too much about this. Give it some thought and share those thoughts in the assignment. So basically what I'm asking you to do is to sort of start planning a new research project that would, in some way, address one or more of these contemporary adaptations. versions, whatever you want to call it, of the Qingming scroll. And I'd like you to choose two or three cases for comparison. And here are some options of what I mean by this: you might choose to stick with one or both of those song-themed parks versus one of the other versions that appear in the unit resources, right? So the mural, the video game, or the television show. That in itself would be a good option for this kind of. So you might choose to say like I'm going to write about, you know, what kind of questions I could ask if we compared the Millennium Park to the Riverside Code TV drama. On the other hand, you might want to choose one of those. theme parks and compare it to some other kind of, you know, theme park or like historical reenactment site or just some other thing that you're familiar with or curious about. This could be something in China. It could be somewhere else. That's up to you. So, for example, you might want to write up some thoughts about what kind of questions you would be interested in if you wanted to compare the Song city in Hangzhou versus Fort Edmonton Park. That's what it's called, right? You know, the sort of historical reenactment city right here in Edmonton. On the other hand, if you want to stay focused on the same region, it might be interesting. to compare this sort of reconstructed version of the Song dynasty atmosphere versus this kind of actual like historical cultural site, sort of buildings and traditional activities going on in this like West Lake area of Hangzhou, in which case we're thinking about, OK, how is a sort of newly constructed historical themed reenactment theme park? How does this compare to what we might actually think of as kind of, you know, world heritage and the sort of serious, you know, perhaps more interested in authenticity, more interested in capturing a certain moment in history, this kind of thing? Right? Or you don't need to write about. either of those song-themed parks might want to focus instead on one of those other examples from the unit resources, and then think about some kind of similar media in a different context that maybe draws inspiration from some different premodern culture or heritage, and then make a comparison in that way. So, for example, you might choose to compare this kind of interactive Minecraft level that's inspired by the Qingming Scroll versus another example of a video game or some other kind of interactive work that's inspired by some other older work of something like this. Lots of options; we're just thinking of comparing. some kind of contemporary version of this Qingming Scroll to some other kind of comparable example.

And what I'd like you to do in the actual part that you write about, I imagine just sort of thinking of some examples will take you some time, and then I'd like you to just sort of briefly describe what a research project that compares these sites or sources might look like. So, of course, you'll want to give an introduction to the examples you would compare. And then, you know, your preliminary thoughts on what they have to do with one another. And importantly, since this module is focused on the Qingming Scroll, like how this can help us understand some element of the contemporary legacy of that scroll better. So, you know, if you're choosing one of the things that has some connection to Qingming and something that's totally unrelated but you find to be comparable, I hope your write-up will focus mostly on how this sort of puts into contrast or sort of brings to light some more issues related to the contemporary legacy of the Qingming Scroll itself. I don't expect this to be fully realized. It's very short, but what you can include is some questions that you hope like ongoing research might answer about these things. And you can kind of think about the kinds of questions that the authors of this chapter pose in their introduction, perhaps without necessarily burdening yourself with, you know, having to come up with an answer, right? And we're just thinking about, you know, why would this study be worth doing. Where it might be nice to include a bit more detail would be in thinking about what this research project would actually look like. So you're mentioning your sources, you're mentioning some of the things you're about curious, but it'll also be great to have a little bit of detail about sources that you would look at beyond just those examples, maybe some other kinds of scholarship that you would sort of seek out to develop this project further. You don't need to be too specific here. You don't need to include a bibliography, but just sort of make reference to things that Ludwig and Wang do in their chapter and say, well, I would want to try to find similar material for this source. If you note that they talk about, let's say, the official website for one of these sites, you could maybe point to the comparable example for whatever other source you're thinking about. So again, you're free to be speculative here, but sort of start to brainstorm a plan for research in your brief write-up about this project. So, as usual, the assignment is very open-ended, very sort of creative focus. The quiz is a little bit more down to earth. In this case, we have two quizzes to take care of. The first of these is, as usual, the unit quiz. Just like the previous two, this is five questions in 10 minutes. This will focus mostly on the article, right? I've sort of pointed you in the direction of some things to think about in relation to that chapter. But the sort of key thing to review for this quiz will be the chapter itself. And perhaps you might want to review some of the material related to heritage from the introductory module. I would like you not to just skip the section on the Beamish Living Museum. Do read through that. But, of course, the focus of this class is not on heritage in the UK, so the sections on the Song Dynasty theme park are more important, and you'll want to have greater familiarity with those sections. For then, after you've done that, there's another quiz to take care of, and this is going to wrap up and conclude this module of the class. This will be a longer quiz: 15 questions in 30 minutes, and it's going to focus on all three past units of the. So, starting with the Hanson reading about the scroll itself, continuing through the second unit of the module, and then also sort of recapping some of the things from this unit as well. Some of these questions are going to be very similar to previous unit quiz questions, but keep in mind that the quiz you take, there's a lot of options in terms of what questions you get right. So some of this may be a fairly direct review of questions you've already answered; others are going to be new; some are going to ask you to maybe make connections or think across the different units of the module to respond to. And in addition to multiple choice format, these are also going to include a few other kinds of questions. These are

all fairly straightforward, so I think the best advice I can give you here is just to read the question instructions carefully and make sure your responses, you know, fulfill those requirements. One simple version of this right is that all of the previous questions have been multiple choice, in which you choose a single response. Some of the questions on the module quiz might involve choosing multiple responses, right? So if it says choose all that apply, you would choose more than one response before submitting. And this should be indicated clearly in the question, so just make sure to read those instructions carefully. Okay, thank you everybody, and I'll see you back for the first unit of the next module.